SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

15 October 2024 · Shift 3

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 12 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.1

A thief is spotted by a policeman at a distance of 300 m. the policeman chases the thief at speed of 10 km/h and the thief is running at a speed of 11 km/h, then the distance between them after 12 minutes is:

(A) 200 m
(B) 500 m
(C) 250 m
(D) 100 m

Q.2

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 320
(B) 240
(C) 220
(D) 280

Q.3

A solid metallic sphere of radius 15 cm is melted and recast into solid spherical balls of radius 3 cm each. What is the ratio of the surface area of the original sphere to the sum of the surface areas of all the balls?

(A) 1 : 5
(B) 2 : 7
(C) 3 : 8
(D) 1 : 3

Q.6

As part of the partial work from home process, Amita went to office every 2nd day, Amrita went to office every 3rd day, and Tosita went to office every 6th day, respectively. All three went to office on 31 October 2021. On how many days did all three attend office on the same date during the remaining two months of the year?

(A) 10
(B) 12
(C) 9
(D) 11

Q.9

A student's final grade is determined by their final examination scores (weighted at 60%) and a final project score (weighted at 40%). If the student scores 75 in the final examination and 90 in the project, then the final grade of the student is:

(A) 82.5
(B) 81.5
(C) 81
(D) 82

Q.10

A trader sells 25 kg of rice at ₹1,400. A customer asks for 15% discount. The shopkeeper agrees to it but instead of 1 kg he gives 10% less rice. What is the effective discount that the customer gets (correct to one decimal place)?

(A) 5.1%
(B) 5.7%
(C) 5.6%
(D) 5.8%

Q.11

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 67 kg and 38 kg is:

(A) 52
(B) 51
(C) 50
(D) 49

Q.12

The ratio of the incomes of Rama and Ganga is 4 : 3 and the ratio of their expenditures is 3 : 2. If each person saves ₹2,700, then find their expenditures, respectively.

(A) ₹8,000 and ₹5,400
(B) ₹8,100 and ₹5,400
(C) ₹8,000 and ₹5,000
(D) ₹8,100 and ₹5,000

Q.14

The average of nine consecutive integers is 54. The second largest of these numbers is:

(A) 57
(B) 50
(C) 58
(D) 59

Q.15

In an election between A and B, A gets double the votes of B and wins with a margin of 150 votes. 10% of votes were invalid. What is the total number of votes polled in the election?

(A) 600
(B) 550
(C) 450
(D) 500

Q.16

A sum of ₹312 was divided among 100 boys and girls in such a way that each boy gets ₹3.60 and each girl ₹2.40. The number of girls is:

(A) 65
(B) 40
(C) 35
(D) 60

Q.17

Two trains 280 metres and 260 metres long, respectively, are running towards each other on parallel lines, one at the speed of 58 km/hr and another at the speed of 50 km/hr. How much time (in seconds) will they take to cross each other?

(A) 15
(B) 18
(C) 17
(D) 12

Q.18

Raman purchased an iron at a cost of ₹2,400 and sold it to Rohan at a loss of 8%. Rohan sold it to Soham at a gain of 12.5%. At what price should Soham sell the iron to gain 15%?

(A) ₹2,856.60
(B) ₹2,658.60
(C) ₹2,860.56
(D) ₹2,568.60

Q.20

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹4000 as a sum borrowed at 4% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 840
(B) 760
(C) 800
(D) 740

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, ‘CORNER’ is written as ‘REORNC’ and ‘BUDGET’ is written as ‘TEUDGB’. How will ‘DEVICE’ be written in that language?

(A) ECIVED
(B) EDEVIC
(C) EVECID
(D) ECEVID

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All pens are markers. Some erasers are pens. Conclusions: (I) Some markers are erasers. (II) All markers are pens.

(A) Only conclusion (I) follows
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(C) Only conclusion (II) follows
(D) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow

Q.4

CJ16 is related to EL26 in a certain way. In the same way, MT42 is related to OV52. To which of the following is HO11 related following the same logic?

(A) JQ31
(B) KS31
(C) JQ21
(D) JK21

Q.5

What will come in the place of ‘?’ in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–‘ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 16 ÷ 8 + 13 + 36 × 18 – 3 = ?

(A) 98
(B) 96
(C) 100
(D) 116

Q.6

In a code language, 'FORK' is coded as ‘GLWD’ and 'CAVF' is coded as ‘DXAY’. How will 'TRHA' be coded in that language?

(A) UOMT
(B) UOPR
(C) UNMS
(D) UONQ

Q.7

JMGI is related to QTNP in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, GJDF is related to NQKM. To which of the following is DGAC related, following the same logic?

(A) NKJH
(B) KNHJ
(C) NKHJ
(D) KNJH

Q.8

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 2, 3, 6, 12, 10, 21, 14, ?

(A) 25
(B) 29
(C) 30
(D) 27

Q.10

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). D sits third to the left of E. G sits second to the left of B. Only E sits between F and G. A is not an immediate neighbour of D. Who sits fourth to the right of C?

(A) E
(B) D
(C) B
(D) A

Q.12

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/ subtracting /multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 22, 31; 26, 35

(A) 48, 52
(B) 32, 49
(C) 44, 59
(D) 38, 47

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'car drive steady' is coded as 'mi ku pa' and 'steady is safe' is coded as 'tu an mi'. How is 'steady' coded in the given language?

(A) an
(B) tu
(C) mi
(D) ku

Q.14

3 is related to 8 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 24 is related to 35. To which of the following is 99 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 120
(B) 80
(C) 143
(D) 110

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some flutes are violins. Some violins are tablas. All tablas are sitars. Conclusions: (I): Some violins are sitars. (II): Some flutes are tablas.

(A) Only conclusion (II) follows
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(C) Only conclusion (I) follows
(D) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow

Q.18

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? BDG, EGJ , HJM, KMP, ?

(A) NPS
(B) PNS
(C) PSN
(D) NSP

Q.19

Seven friends, A, B, C, D, E, F and G, are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order) . D is an immediate neighbour of both A and F. B is sitting to the immediate right of F. C is sitting second to the left of A. G and E both are C's immediate neighbours and G is not an immediate neighbour of A. Who is the immediate neighbour of both B and D?

(A) G
(B) A
(C) C
(D) F

Q.20

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 35 × 7 ÷ 6 + 3 – 14 = ?

(A) 35
(B) 42
(C) 39
(D) 41

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Where was the inaugural match of the first edition of the Women's Premier League (WPL) organised in the year 2023?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Dharamshala
(C) Mumbai
(D) Bengaluru

Q.2

The cytoplasmic zone surrounding the Golgi complex possesses no cell organelles. This zone of clear cytoplasm is called:

(A) zone of exclusion
(B) cytosol
(C) cytosine
(D) cytochrome

Q.3

Which of the following is NOT included in the three main dimensions of the New Industrial Policy, 1991, announced by the Government of India?

(A) Liberalisation
(B) Globalisation
(C) Privatisation
(D) Urbanisation

Q.4

When was India's first ever budget presented?

(A) 1948
(B) 1860
(C) 1935
(D) 1857

Q.5

Udit Narayan was conferred the Padma Bhushan in 2016 for which of the following fields?

(A) Art - Playback Singing
(B) Art - Theatre
(C) Art - Classical Dance
(D) Public Affairs

Q.6

If an Indian citizen is denied entry to a public place because of his caste, which of the following Fundamental Rights is denied to him?

(A) Right against exploitation
(B) Right to equality
(C) Right to constitutional remedies
(D) Cultural and educational right

Q.7

Who among the following was one of the founders of the Indian National Congress in 1885?

(A) Charles Freer Andrews
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Allan Octavian Hume
(D) Annie Besant

Q.8

'Ram Navami' is celebrated in India to commemorate the:

(A) death of Ravana.
(B) birth of Lord Rama.
(C) return of Lord Rama from forest.
(D) coronation ceremony of Lord Rama as a king.

Q.9

Which river is known as 'Langchen Khambab' in Tibet?

(A) Indus
(B) Sutlej
(C) Kosi
(D) Tista

Q.10

As per the reforms of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2023, how many minerals have been removed from the list of atomic minerals?

(A) 6
(B) 3
(C) 8
(D) 11

Q.11

Who was the highest run scorer in Men's World Cup cricket - 2019?

(A) Virat Kohli
(B) Shikhar Dhawan
(C) Rohit Sharma
(D) DA Warner

Q.12

'Chakyar Koothu', the folk dance form in which the entire story is presented by a single performer, primarily belongs to which of the following states?

(A) Kerala
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Tripura
(D) Sikkim

Q.14

In February 2024, who took an oath as the 12th Chief Minister of Jharkhand?

(A) Saryu Rai
(B) Babulal Marandi
(C) Champai Soren
(D) Arjun Munda

Q.15

National Prophylaxis Program, which was launched in 1970 as an immediate remedial measure to address which of the following medical conditions /diseases caused by nutritional deficiencies?

(A) Hypercalcemia
(B) Blindness
(C) Beriberi
(D) Goitre

Q.16

Which Article of the Constitution directs the Council of Ministers to aid and advise the Governor?

(A) Article 157
(B) Article 163
(C) Article 153
(D) Article 167

Q.17

The approximate number of water molecules present in 9 gm of water is _____.

(A) 6.022×10^{22}
(B) 6.022×10^{23}
(C) 3.011×10^{23}
(D) 9.023×10^{23}

Q.18
K Kalyanasundaram Pillai was honoured with the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award, 1999, for his contribution to which of the following dance forms?

(A) Mohiniyattam
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Bharatnatyam
(D) Manipuri

Q.19
'The Blue Umbrella', 'The Cherry Tree', 'The Hidden Pool' are novels written by who among the following authors?

(A) Sudha Murthy
(B) Anant Pai
(C) Twinkle Khanna
(D) Ruskin Bond

Q.20
Who among the following was defeated by Babur in the Battle of Khanwa in 1527 CE?

(A) Hasan Khan
(B) Medini Rai
(C) Rana Sanga
(D) Ibrahim Lodi

Q.21
Which of the following sectors had the largest percentage of workforce in urban India in the year 2019-2020?

(A) Service
(B) Agriculture
(C) Mining
(D) Industry

Q.22
Bal Gangadhar described _____ as a diamond of India.

(A) Motilal Nehru
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Baba Saheb Ambedkar
(D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Q.23
A portion of landmass from the shore line up to the shelf break that is submerged under shallow water is known as:

(A) Continental Drift
(B) Oceanic Basin
(C) Trenches
(D) Continental Shelf

Q.24
What is the overarching programme introduced in the Union Budget, 2018-19 by Government of India, for the school education sector?

(A) Right to Education
(B) Samagra Shiksha
(C) Rashtriya Unnat Shiksha Abhiyan
(D) Sarva Vidya Abhiyan

Q.25
Harshvardhan's ambitions of extending his power to Deccan and South India were stopped by:

(A) Pulakesin II
(B) Ashoka
(C) Rajaraja I
(D) Vikramaditya

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I have lived with my parents / in Mumbai / in a residential flat / yet two years.

(A) in Mumbai
(B) I have lived with my parents
(C) yet two years
(D) in a residential flat

Q.2

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Mosquito means small fly. It has a transmitter segmented body and a _____ of wings. Male mosquitoes mainly feed on plant _____.

(A) couple; liquor
(B) set; beverage
(C) pair; nectar
(D) kind; drink

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. Many fraud companies _____ (deceive) innocent customers and earn millions of dollars.

(A) facilitate
(B) mislead
(C) hamper
(D) resolve

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. She "prepares an unique" dish in the cooking competition and won it.

(A) prepared an unique
(B) prepares a unique
(C) prepared a unique
(D) No substitution required

Q.5

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. A fox and an hyena were spotted in the animal reserve.

(A) were spotted in
(B) the animal reserve
(C) and an hyena
(D) A fox

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given proverb. Bite the bullet

(A) To be the first to attack someone
(B) To face up to trouble with fortitude
(C) To buy something with no prior inspection
(D) To take the blame for something one didn't do

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the following sentence. I "graciously" welcomed my boss at my birthday party.

(A) Cleverly
(B) Courageously
(C) Bravely
(D) Nicely

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. To his "surprise", it swung back at his touch.

(A) Shock
(B) Anger
(C) Boredom
(D) Regret

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The questions in part B looks "difficult" than the questions in part A.

(A) most difficult
(B) difficultier
(C) difficultly
(D) more difficult

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The soldiers "are all on their toes and anxiously waiting" for the orders to start marching towards the enemy.

(A) all on their fingers and anxiously waiting
(B) paying through the nose
(C) No substitution required
(D) all on their toes and anxiously dancing

Q.11

What is the correct substitution for the word 'screw' in the idiom 'Hit the screw on the head'?

(A) Crew
(B) Bolt
(C) Tack
(D) Nail

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Futile

(A) Thoughtful
(B) Useless
(C) Vicious
(D) Adequate

Q.13

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. We have pledged our "allegance" to the nation.

(A) allegaince
(B) alegiance
(C) ellegance
(D) allegiance

Q.14

Select the sentence that has a grammatical error.

(A) She always cuts out unhealthy snacks.
(B) Can you cut through the traffic to get here on time?
(C) They need to cut down the old tree in the garden.
(D) The manager cuts the discussion to address an urgent matter.

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Ephemeral

(A) Ugly
(B) Permanent
(C) Pleasing
(D) Transient

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The student received an _____ for his outstanding performance.

(A) acolayd
(B) accolade
(C) acolade
(D) accolad

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. We have perhaps never seen an "ablest" series of advocates than these ten standing in a row.

(A) the ablest
(B) abler
(C) more able
(D) most ablest

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He had always wanted to work for himself; so, last year he _____ his job at the bank and is now running a tool business.

(A) left
(B) cleft
(C) bereft
(D) halted

Q.19

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word from the given sentence. The chef's delicious recipies are a favourite among the restaurant's patrons.

(A) Recipies
(B) Chef's
(C) Delicious
(D) Restaurant's

Q.20

Select the most appropriate degree of comparison to fill in the blank. Work in this office is done in the _____ way.

(A) lesser efficient way
(B) less efficient
(C) least efficient
(D) little efficient

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Are you familiar with the movie 'Jurassic Park'? Do you recall the enormous dinosaurs? Do you know that there is still a mammal that is as big and amazing as them? Blue whales are the world's largest living things and (1)_____ vast oceanic expanses. The adult is more than 100 feet long and (2)_____ more than 190 metric tons. According to scientists, a blue whale's heart weighs as much as a car while its tongue weighs as much as an elephant! They eat meat, but they don't have teeth. They gulp and swallow huge quantities of krill and shrimp for their diet. Their mouths have bristles that look like combs and remove water while keeping their food (3)_____. Whales are social animals that live in 'pods', which are made up of more females than males. They take care of their children. Another female takes over and cares for the calf if one mother is unable to provide it with milk. Their bond is very strong, and they cry when another whale dies. The male makes sure that everyone in the pod gets their fair share of food. Whistles, clock-like sounds, and songs—frequent, high-pitched sounds—are the means by which the whales (4)_____ with one another. It assists them in locating one another, locating the position of the pod, searching for prey, and attracting mates. Every pod has a distinctive song that sets it apart from the others. These songs can be heard for not only hours, but also days (5)_____ miles of ocean.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) depart
(B) inhabit
(C) engage
(D) employ

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Are you familiar with the movie 'Jurassic Park'? Do you recall the enormous dinosaurs? Do you know that there is still a mammal that is as big and amazing as them? Blue whales are the world's largest living things and (1)_____ vast oceanic expanses. The adult is more than 100 feet long and (2)_____ more than 190 metric tons. According to scientists, a blue whale's heart weighs as much as a car while its tongue weighs as much as an elephant! They eat meat, but they don't have teeth. They gulp and swallow huge quantities of krill and shrimp for their diet. Their mouths have bristles that look like combs and remove water while keeping their food (3)_____. Whales are social animals that live in 'pods', which are made up of more females than males. They take care of their children. Another female takes over and cares for the calf if one mother is unable to provide it with milk. Their bond is very strong, and they cry when another whale dies. The male makes sure that everyone in the pod gets their fair share of food. Whistles, clock-like sounds, and songs—frequent, high-pitched sounds—are the means by which the whales (4)_____ with one another. It assists them in locating one another, locating the position of the pod, searching for prey, and attracting mates. Every pod has a distinctive song that sets it apart from the others. These songs can be heard for not only hours, but also days (5)_____ miles of ocean.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) loads
(B) lifts
(C) weighs
(D) counts

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Are you familiar with the movie 'Jurassic Park'? Do you recall the enormous dinosaurs? Do you know that there is still a mammal that is as big and amazing as them? Blue whales are the world's largest living things and (1)_____ vast oceanic expanses. The adult is more than 100 feet long and (2)_____ more than 190 metric tons. According to scientists, a blue whale's heart weighs as much as a car while its tongue weighs as much as an elephant! They eat meat, but they don't have teeth. They gulp and swallow huge quantities of krill and shrimp for their diet. Their mouths have bristles that look like combs and remove water while keeping their food (3)_____. Whales are social animals that live in 'pods', which are made up of more females than males. They take care of their children. Another female takes over and cares for the calf if one mother is unable to provide it with milk. Their bond is very strong, and they cry when another whale dies. The male makes sure that everyone in the pod gets their fair share of food. Whistles, clock-like sounds, and songs—frequent, high-pitched sounds—are the means by which the whales (4)_____ with one another. It assists them in locating one another, locating the position of the pod, searching for prey, and attracting mates. Every pod has a distinctive song that sets it apart from the others. These songs can be heard for not only hours, but also days (5)_____ miles of ocean.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) beckon
(B) intact
(C) brokerage
(D) fair

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Are you familiar with the movie 'Jurassic Park'? Do you recall the enormous dinosaurs? Do you know that there is still a mammal that is as big and amazing as them? Blue whales are the world's largest living things and (1)_____ vast oceanic expanses. The adult is more than 100 feet long and (2)_____ more than 190 metric tons. According to scientists, a blue whale's heart weighs as much as a car while its tongue weighs as much as an elephant! They eat meat, but they don't have teeth. They gulp and swallow huge quantities of krill and shrimp for their diet. Their mouths have bristles that look like combs and remove water while keeping their food (3)_____. Whales are social animals that live in 'pods', which are made up of more females than males. They take care of their children. Another female takes over and cares for the calf if one mother is unable to provide it with milk. Their bond is very strong, and they cry when another whale dies. The male makes sure that everyone in the pod gets their fair share of food. Whistles, clock-like sounds, and songs—frequent, high-pitched sounds—are the means by which the whales (4)_____ with one another. It assists them in locating one another, locating the position of the pod, searching for prey, and attracting mates. Every pod has a distinctive song that sets it apart from the others. These songs can be heard for not only hours, but also days (5)_____ miles of ocean.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) meet
(B) horrid
(C) communicate
(D) catch

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Are you familiar with the movie 'Jurassic Park'? Do you recall the enormous dinosaurs? Do you know that there is still a mammal that is as big and amazing as them? Blue whales are the world's largest living things and (1)_____ vast oceanic expanses. The adult is more than 100 feet long and (2)_____ more than 190 metric tons. According to scientists, a blue whale's heart weighs as much as a car while its tongue weighs as much as an elephant! They eat meat, but they don't have teeth. They gulp and swallow huge quantities of krill and shrimp for their diet. Their mouths have bristles that look like combs and remove water while keeping their food (3)_____. Whales are social animals that live in 'pods', which are made up of more females than males. They take care of their children. Another female takes over and cares for the calf if one mother is unable to provide it with milk. Their bond is very strong, and they cry when another whale dies. The male makes sure that everyone in the pod gets their fair share of food. Whistles, clock-like sounds, and songs—frequent, high-pitched sounds—are the means by which the whales (4)_____ with one another. It assists them in locating one another, locating the position of the pod, searching for prey, and attracting mates. Every pod has a distinctive song that sets it apart from the others. These songs can be heard for not only hours, but also days (5)_____ miles of ocean.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) although
(B) across
(C) off
(D) beside

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**
Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (B) 500 m

The thief is faster by 11 − 10 = 1 km/h, so in 12 minutes (1/5 hour) he gains 0.2 km = 200 m. The gap grows to 300 + 200 = 500 m.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 280

SI = 2000 × 7 × 2/100 = ₹280.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 1 : 5

By volume the sphere makes $(15/3)^3 = 125$ balls. Surface areas: $4\pi \times 15^2 : 125 \times 4\pi \times 3^2 = 225 : 1125 = 1 : 5$.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 10

All three are in together every LCM(2, 3, 6) = 6 days. November and December have 61 days, and the sixth, twelfth, ..., sixtieth day after 31 October fall within them (the last is 30 December): 10 days.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 81

Weighted average: 0.6 × 75 + 0.4 × 90 = 45 + 36 = 81.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 5.6%

The customer pays 85% of the price for 90% of the rice, so the effective price is 0.85/0.9 = 94.4% of the original: a discount of about 5.6%.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 50

(40 + 49 + 56 + 67 + 38)/5 = 250/5 = 50 kg.

Q.12 · Answer (B) ₹8,100 and ₹5,400

With incomes 4x, 3x and expenditures 3y, 2y: 4x − 3y = 2,700 and 3x − 2y = 2,700. Subtracting gives x = y, so x = y = 2,700 and the expenditures are ₹8,100 and ₹5,400.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 57

Nine consecutive integers averaging 54 run from 50 to 58, so the second largest is 57.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 500

A = 2B and A − B = 150, so B = 150 and A = 300: 450 valid votes. These are 90% of the votes polled, so 450/0.9 = 500 were polled.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 40

With b boys: 3.60b + 2.40(100 − b) = 312, so 1.2b = 72 and b = 60. The other 40 are girls.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 18

Moving towards each other, their relative speed is 58 + 50 = 108 km/h = 30 m/s. They cover 280 + 260 = 540 m in 540/30 = 18 seconds.

Q.18 · Answer (A) ₹2,856.60

Rohan paid 2,400 × 0.92 = ₹2,208 and Soham paid 2,208 × 1.125 = ₹2,484. For a 15% gain Soham must sell at 2,484 × 1.15 = ₹2,856.60.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 800

SI = 4000 × 4 × 5/100 = ₹800.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (D) ECEVID

The code takes the 6th, 5th, 2nd, 3rd, 4th and 1st letters: CORNER → R E O R N C and BUDGET → T E U D G B. So DEVICE → E C E V I D: ECEVID.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Only conclusion (I) follows
Some erasers are pens and all pens are markers, so those erasers are markers: some markers are erasers (I). Nothing says every marker is a pen, so II does not follow.

Q.4 · Answer (C) JQ21
Each letter moves 2 places forward and the number rises by 10: C → E, J → L, 16 → 26, and M → O, T → V, 42 → 52. So HO11 → JQ21.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 116
After interchanging the signs: 16 × 8 – 13 – 36 ÷ 18 + 3 = 128 – 13 – 2 + 3 = 116.

Q.6 · Answer (A) UOMT
The letters move +1, –3, +5, –7, wrapping round the alphabet: F → G, O → L, R → W, K → D. So T → U, R → O, H → M and A → T: UOMT.

Q.7 · Answer (B) KNHJ
Each letter moves 7 places forward: J → Q, M → T, G → N, I → P. So D → K, G → N, A → H, C → J: KNHJ.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 30
Two series alternate: 2, 6, 10, 14 (+4) and 3, 12, 21 (+9). The next term of the second is 21 + 9 = 30.

Q.10 · Answer (D) A
Going round the table to each person's left from E: E, F, C, D, B, A, G. Then D is third to the left of E, G second to the left of B, only E sits between F and G, and A is not next to D. Counting four places to C's right (F, E, G, A) gives A.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 38, 47
The second number is the first plus 9: 22 + 9 = 31 and 26 + 9 = 35. Likewise 38 + 9 = 47.

Q.13 · Answer (C) mi
'steady' is the only word in both sentences and 'mi' the only code in both, so steady = mi.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 120
$3 = 2^2 – 1$ goes to $3^2 – 1 = 8$, and $24 = 5^2 – 1$ goes to $6^2 – 1 = 35$. So $99 = 10^2 – 1$ goes to $11^2 – 1 = 120$.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Only conclusion (I) follows
The violins that are tablas are also sitars, so some violins are sitars (I). The flutes that are violins need not be among the violins that are tablas, so II does not follow.

Q.18 · Answer (A) NPS
Each letter moves 3 places forward from one cluster to the next: K → N, M → P, P → S: NPS.

Q.19 · Answer (D) F
Going round the table to each person's left from D: D, A, E, C, G, B, F. This fits every clue (B to F's immediate right, C second to A's left, G and E beside C, G not beside A), and F sits between B and D.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 41
After interchanging the signs: 35 ÷ 7 × 6 – 3 + 14 = 30 – 3 + 14 = 41.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Mumbai
The first WPL match, Mumbai Indians against Gujarat Giants on 4 March 2023, was played at the DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai.

Q.2 · Answer (A) zone of exclusion
The clear, organelle-free cytoplasm around the Golgi complex is the zone of exclusion. Cytosol is the fluid of the cytoplasm in general, cytosine a nitrogen base and cytochromes respiratory proteins.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Urbanisation
The New Industrial Policy of 1991 rested on liberalisation, privatisation and globalisation (LPG); urbanisation was not one of them.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 1860
India's first budget was presented on 7 April 1860 by James Wilson, the finance member of the Viceroy's council.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Art - Playback Singing
Udit Narayan is a film playback singer; his 2016 Padma Bhushan was in Art (playback singing).

Q.6 · Answer (B) Right to equality
Article 15(2), part of the Right to Equality, bars any restriction on a citizen's access to shops, public restaurants, hotels and places of public entertainment, or use of places of public resort, on grounds only of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Allan Octavian Hume
Allan Octavian Hume, a retired British civil servant, helped found the Indian National Congress, which first met in Bombay in December 1885.

Q.8 · Answer (B) birth of Lord Rama.
Ram Navami, on the ninth day of the bright half of Chaitra, marks the birth of Lord Rama.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Sutlej
The Sutlej, which rises near Rakas Tal close to Mansarovar, is known as Langchen Khambab in Tibet.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 6
The 2023 amendment took six minerals off the list of atomic minerals: lithium, beryllium, titanium, niobium, tantalum and zirconium.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Rohit Sharma
Rohit Sharma scored 648 runs, with five centuries, at the 2019 World Cup, one more than David Warner's 647.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Kerala
Chakyar Koothu, in which a single Chakyar performer narrates stories from the epics, is a temple art of Kerala.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Champai Soren
Champai Soren was sworn in as Chief Minister of Jharkhand on 2 February 2024, after Hemant Soren resigned.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Blindness
The National Prophylaxis Programme against Nutritional Blindness (1970) gives young children large doses of vitamin A, whose deficiency causes night blindness and can lead to permanent blindness.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Article 163
Article 163 provides a Council of Ministers, headed by the Chief Minister, to aid and advise the Governor.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 3.011×10^{23}
9 g of water is 9/18 = 0.5 mole, and a mole holds 6.022×10^{23} molecules: $0.5 \times 6.022 \times 10^{23} = 3.011 \times 10^{23}$.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Bharatnatyam
K. Kalyanasundaram Pillai, a Bharatanatyam guru, received the 1999 Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for that dance form.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Ruskin Bond
'The Blue Umbrella', 'The Cherry Tree' and 'The Hidden Pool' are all by Ruskin Bond.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Rana Sanga
At Khanwa in 1527 Babur defeated Rana Sanga of Mewar; Hasan Khan Mewati and Medini Rai fought on Sanga's side. Ibrahim Lodi had fallen at Panipat in 1526.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Service
In 2019-20 the service sector employed the largest share of urban workers, ahead of industry; agriculture's share in towns and cities is small.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
SSC's key gives Gopal Krishna Gokhale. Tilak, his political rival, is quoted as calling him 'this diamond of India, this jewel of Maharashtra' in his tribute when Gokhale died in 1915.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Continental Shelf
The continental shelf is the gently sloping, shallowly submerged edge of a continent, from the shore to the shelf break, where the continental slope begins.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Samagra Shiksha
Samagra Shiksha, announced in the 2018-19 Union Budget, merged the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan and Teacher Education into one scheme for school education from pre-school to Class 12.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Pulakesin II
The Chalukya king Pulakesin II defeated Harsha on the Narmada, as his Aihole inscription records, and so stopped Harsha's advance to the south.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) yet two years
A length of time with the present perfect takes 'for': 'I have lived ... for two years', not 'yet two years'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) pair; nectar
Wings come in a 'pair', and male mosquitoes feed on plant 'nectar'; only the females feed on blood.

Q.3 · Answer (B) mislead
To 'mislead' is to deceive: to make someone believe what is untrue.

Q.4 · Answer (C) prepared a unique
The sentence is in the past ('won it'), so 'prepared'; and 'unique' begins with a 'yoo' sound, so it takes 'a'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) and an hyena
The 'h' in 'hyena' is sounded, so it takes 'a': 'a fox and a hyena'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) To face up to trouble with fortitude
To 'bite the bullet' is to face something difficult or unpleasant with courage.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Nicely
'Graciously' means kindly and courteously; 'nicely' is the closest. 'Courageously' and 'bravely' mean with courage, 'cleverly' with skill.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Shock
'Surprise' is the feeling caused by something unexpected; of the options only 'shock' is close.

Q.9 · Answer (D) more difficult
Two things are compared with 'than', so the comparative 'more difficult' is needed; 'difficultier' is not a word. (Strictly, the plural 'questions' also needs 'look', but that word is not underlined.)

Q.10 · Answer (C) No substitution required
To be 'on one's toes' is to be alert and ready, which fits soldiers anxiously waiting to march.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Nail
The idiom is 'hit the nail on the head': to describe something exactly right.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Useless
'Futile' means producing no result: 'useless'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) allegiance
The correct spelling is 'allegiance'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) The manager cuts the discussion to address an urgent matter.
To end a discussion early is to 'cut it short': 'The manager cuts the discussion short'. 'Cut out', 'cut through' and 'cut down' are used correctly in the others.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Transient
'Ephemeral' means lasting a very short time: 'transient'. 'Permanent' is its opposite.

Q.16 · Answer (B) accolade
The correct spelling is 'accolade', an award or mark of praise.

Q.17 · Answer (B) abler
With 'than' the comparative is needed, and 'an' needs a vowel sound: 'an abler series of advocates than these ten'. 'More able' would need 'a'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) left
To 'leave' a job is to quit it. 'Cleft' means split and 'bereft' deprived, and one does not 'halt' a job.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Recipies
The correct spelling is 'recipes'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) least efficient
'The' before the blank calls for the superlative: 'the least efficient way'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) inhabit
Blue whales 'inhabit', that is live in, vast oceanic expanses.

Q.22 · Answer (C) weighs
The adult 'weighs' more than 190 metric tons; the next sentence uses the same verb for its heart and tongue.

Q.23 · Answer (B) intact
The bristles let the water out while keeping the food 'intact', that is whole, with none of it lost.

Q.24 · Answer (C) communicate
Whistles and songs are the means by which the whales 'communicate' with one another, to find each other and attract mates.

Q.25 · Answer (B) across
The songs carry 'across' miles of ocean, over that whole distance.

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